



Payments that don't depend on trust

An escrow app on Stellar that lets a small shop buy from a supplier without either of them taking the risk first.

Many hands lift what one alone cannot.

Cintia Venecia · Octavio Giménez Bravo
Salta, Argentina · Argentina Builder Challenge 2026

THE PROBLEM

Small shops in Argentina are mostly informal, and they close fast

65.8%

of self-employed workers
are unregistered (2026)

76%

of unregistered private jobs
are in businesses with fewer
than 10 people

34%

of business closures were
companies under 3 years old
(2024–2025)

28,262

businesses with
employees lost from Dec
2023 to mid-2026

Informal shops don't even show up in these numbers, and they probably last even less.

Sources: INDEC, UBA, Ministry of Human Capital, SRT (as cited by the press). Full study: docs/estudio-pequenos-comercios.html

WHAT WE HEARD · REAL SMALL BUSINESSES IN ARGENTINA

Informal trade runs on personal trust, until one link breaks



Lourdes · sewing workshop

“All suppliers ask you to pay them upfront.”



Cintia · former bakery

“I never had access to credit because both my suppliers and I worked informally.”



Ruperto · electronics

Pays suppliers in Bolivia upfront. A courier and a driver bring the goods, on their word.



Antonio y Nelly · cleaning

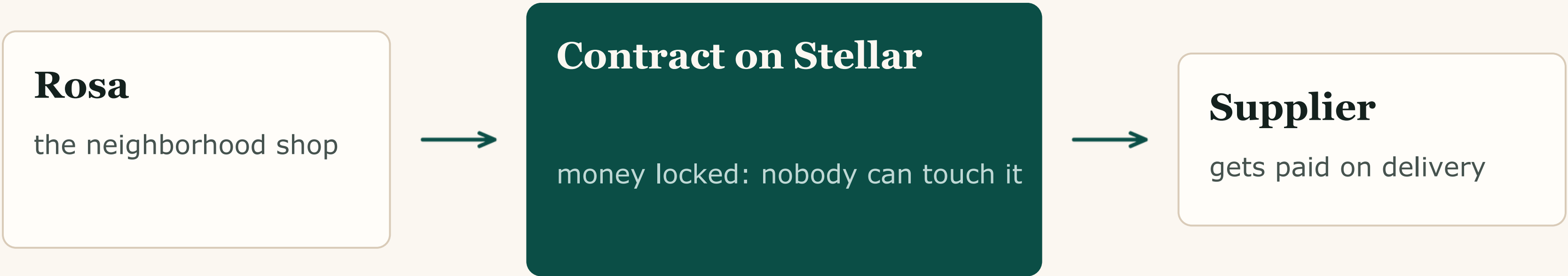
Pays on delivery, in person. Wishes for price comparison in the area.

It works today, but nothing guarantees it will tomorrow. Minga puts the guarantee in the payment, not in the people.

Mom Test interviews: past facts, not opinions. Quotes translated from Spanish. Everyone shown consented to publication.

THE SOLUTION

Minga holds the money in the middle



1

Rosa places the order and picks how many days she needs to check it. Her money is locked.

2

The supplier looks up the order number and sees the payment is guaranteed.

3

Rosa confirms the goods arrived, and the contract pays the supplier.

4

If the order doesn't go through, Rosa cancels and gets everything back.

On screen, Rosa only reads "Order created" and "Payment released". No crypto words: no "escrow", "wallet" or "transaction".

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

The supplier is protected too

The supplier can sign “I delivered”. That starts the clock on the time limit Rosa chose (1 to 60 days).

Rosa confirms

The supplier gets paid.

Rosa says nothing and time runs out

The supplier gets paid anyway.
Silence no longer hurts them.

Rosa objects in time

The money is frozen until one side gives in: Rosa releases it, or the supplier returns it.



Not solved yet: a dispute where neither side gives in. That needs a mediator, who decides where the money goes but can never keep it.

Real orders on a real contract

Order	What it shows	Status
129183	Money locked, waiting for the goods	Pending
125388	Created, delivered, confirmed and paid	Payment released
287573	Another full journey, end to end	Payment released

29 tests

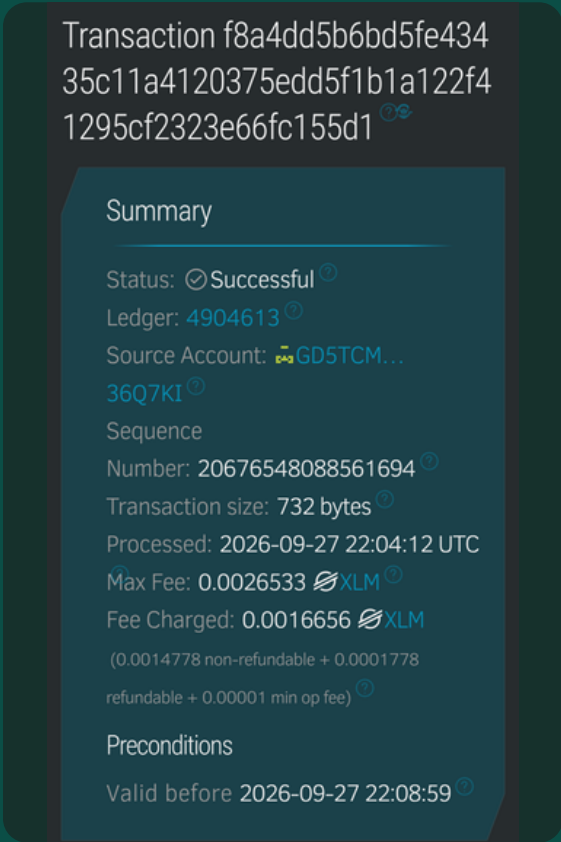
automated, all passing

Public events

every change of state is on the network, so both sides can prove what they did

Live app

minga-r5ql.vercel.app



A real order on the network, 27 Sep 2026: Successful

REAL USER TEST · ALONE, ON HIS PHONE

He got stuck where we expected, and we fixed it the same day

~10 min

trying on his own, in
Chrome with xBull

3 / 5

how easy it was without
help

1 time

we stepped in: xBull wasn't in
the Play Store, so we opened it
through Google

No order

his new wallet had no test
funds, and the app didn't say
so clearly

“I don't know what happened, what step was
missing in the middle.”

He also saw the red error box and said it helped, but its text (“user
closed the modal, code –1”) made no sense to him.

Fixed and live, 26 Sep

“Load test money” button: the app spots an empty wallet
as soon as it connects and funds it in one tap.

Plain message when you close the wallet: nothing happened, your money didn't move.

Ruperto, CompraLinda (Cintia's brother) · Android phone, no guidance · quotes translated from Spanish

SECURITY

A flaw we found and fixed

Before: fake currency

Anyone could create an order in a worthless token. The supplier would see “payment guaranteed”, deliver real goods and get paid in nothing.

Now: currency fixed at deploy

The currency is set once, when the contract is installed, and no function can change it. Anyone can check it with `get_token`.

No owner, no admin

Nobody, not even us, can touch the money of an order.

Property tests

Thousands of random cases check that the numbers always add up.

Honest about limits

Internal review, not an audit. External audit planned via the SCF Audit Bank.

BUSINESS MODEL

The supplier pays, not Rosa

DECIDED, TO START

1%

per completed sale, charged to the supplier. They gain guaranteed payment from shops that couldn't buy from them before.

PLANNED, WITH STAGE 4

Microloans

When a shop's payment history is enough for credit: a margin on the loan, or an origination fee with a financial partner.

Why not charge Rosa? She's the person the system leaves out today. Charging her would repeat the very problem Minga solves.

Still to measure: the trustline reserve (0.5 XLM per account) and anchor fees for cash-out.

ROADMAP

Escrow came first: it's the one piece that needs a blockchain

NOW · DONE

Escrow

Live on testnet. Next: order history read from the network.

STAGE 1

Record without typing

A photo of the receipt, stock alerts, orders via WhatsApp.

STAGE 2

La Feria

A shared price library, dated, across all kinds of shops.

STAGE 3

Reputation

Completed payments become a history nobody can take away.

STAGE 4

Credit without a bank

Ask for a loan by showing what you did, not papers you don't have.

Many hands lift what one alone cannot.

minga-r5ql.vercel.app
github.com/veneciaedith/minga